

JESSICA HICKLE

Yale University

Department of Political Science

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EDUCATION

Yale University

PhD, Political Science. Expected 2028.

- *Dissertation*: Judicializing Electoral Politics: The Causes and Consequences of Post-Election Litigation
- *Committee*: Kate Baldwin (chair), Jennifer Gandhi, Egor Lazarev
- *Fields*: Comparative Politics, International Relations, Qualitative and Archival Methods

MPhil, Political Science. 2025.

MA, Political Science. 2025.

Georgetown University

BS, International Politics (*cum laude*). 2018.

- *Minors*: African Studies, French

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

- Jessica Hickle. 2022. "Case Sensitive: Lawyers and the Formation of Legal Arguments in Tanzania." *Law and Social Inquiry*.

SELECTED ANALYSIS & GENERAL INTEREST PUBLICATIONS

- Jessica Hickle. 2026. "[Two alders want to cater to local caterers by lowering license fees](#)." *Yale Daily News*.
- Jessica Hickle. 2023. "[The State of the Evidence: Debt Transparency](#)." *Open Government Partnership*.
- Jessica Hickle. 2020. "[Domestic Resource Mobilization and Economic Recovery in Africa](#)." *Open Government Partnership*.

GRANTS

- Georg Walter Leitner Program in International and Comparative Political Economy Grant (\$5,000). 2026.
- Lindsay Fellowship for Research in Africa (\$2,000). 2026.
- Humane Studies Fellowship (\$3,000). 2025.
- MacMillan Center International Dissertation Research Fellowship (\$18,000). 2025.
- MacMillan Center International Conference Travel Grant (\$800). 2025; 2026.
- MacMillan Center Pre-Dissertation Research Fellowship (\$5,000). 2024.
- Raines Research Fellowship (\$5,000). 2017.
- Improving the Human Condition Grant (\$3,000). 2017.

PRESENTATIONS

- American Political Science Association. 2021; 2025 (declined); 2026 (planned).
- Midwest Political Science Association. 2025; 2026.
- African Studies Association. 2026 (planned).

- Yale Center for the Study of American Politics Summer Workshop. 2025.
- Yale MacMillan Comparative Politics Workshop. 2026.
- European Conference of African Studies. 2025 (declined).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Yale University, Department of Political Science

- (planned) Elections, Institutions, and Contestation in Africa. Co-instructor of Record (with Kate Baldwin). Fall 2026.
- Nationalism and Ethnic Politics. Teaching Fellow. Spring 2025; Spring 2026. Instructor: Maria Jose Hierro.
- Law and Political Development. Teaching Fellow. Fall 2024. Instructor: Egor Lazarev.

Wesleyan University, Department of Government

- (planned) Elections, Institutions, and Contestation in Africa. Instructor of Record. Fall 2026.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Graduate Writing Lab at the Poorvu Center for Teaching and Learning (Yale)

- Writing mentor. 2026-present.

Freelance Copy Editor

- Academic and policy writing. 2023-present.

Open Government Partnership

- Research Officer. 2018-2022. Washington, D.C.
- Consultant. 2023. Remote.

Digital Fieldwork (website)

- Project Manager. 2020-2022.

Georgetown University Institute for Innovation, Development, and Evaluation (gui2de)

- Research Assistant for Ken Opalo and James Habyarimana. 2016-2018.

SERVICE

- Graduate Student Coordinator. Comparative Politics Workshop. Yale University. AY 2023-2024.
- Departmental Representative. Graduate Student Assembly. Yale University. AY 2023-2024.
- Co-organizer with Kate Baldwin. Meeting of the Boston-Area Working Group on African Politics and Economics (B-WGAPE). 2023.
- Writing Mentor. Center for Research and Fellowships. Georgetown University. 2021-Present.

SKILLS & FIELDWORK

Technical: R, STATA, Latex, R Markdown, SurveyCTO, Trint

Language: English (native), French (professional proficiency), Kiswahili (basic)

Fieldwork: Malawi (2025), Senegal (2024), Tanzania (2016, 2017)